



A cabin arriving at one of the gondola's hillside stations.

SMILEY.TOERIST [HTTPS://COMMONS.WIKIMEDIA.ORG/WIKI/FILE:MAOKONG_GONDOLA_2014_3.JPG] · CC BY-SA 4.0 [HTTPS://CREATIVECOMMONS.ORG/LICENSES/BY-SA/4.0] · WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

[← Back to Rail](#)

Maokong Gondola

Taipei's first cable car and Taiwan's longest — a TRTC-family ropeway whose T16 tower was undermined by a 2008 typhoon, investigated by the Control Yuan, and rebuilt 30 metres from where it stood.

MAOKONG GONDOLA			
OPERATOR North Metro Recreation Company (北捷遊憩事業股份有限公司), a TRTC [/rail/operators/trtc/]Taipei City joint subsidiary ^[11]	DISTRICT Wenshan District, Taipei [/rail/thsr/stations/taipei/] ^[1]	OPENED 4 July 2007 ^[1]	ROPEWAY MANUFACTURER POMA (France) ^[2]
STATIONS 4 passenger stations, 2 non-boarding angle stations ^[4]	MAJOR INCIDENT T16 tower foundation undermined by Typhoon Jangmi, September 2008; suspended 1 October 2008 – 30 March 2010; tower relocated ~30 m ^[2]		

Taipei [/rail/thsr/stations/taipei/]'s cable car climbs from the zoo to a tea-growing hillside on a line that is, for a tourist ride, unusually well documented by the government that owns it — because in 2008 one of its towers nearly fell into a residential neighbourhood, and the Control Yuan wrote a 22-page corrective resolution about why^[2].

The system

The Maokong Gondola opened 4 July 2007, built by Taipei City's New Construction Office to a design supplied by the French ropeway manufacturer POMA, with 財團法人中華顧問工程司 (renamed 台灣世曦工程顧問股份有限公司 partway through the project) and 武林建築師事務所 supervising and 春原營造股份有限公司 building it as design-build contractor under a 最有利標 ("most advantageous tender") award of 2 May 2005^[1] ^[2]. It was Taipei's first cable car^[9] and is reported as Taiwan's longest gondola route^[10].

The line runs 4.033 km — published as 4.03 km throughout the construction-era and Control Yuan record, almost certainly the same figure carried to one more decimal place on the operator's current site rather than a real disagreement^[4]. It has **four passenger stations** — 動物園站 [/rail/cable/stations/zoo-station/] Zoo Station, 動物園南站 [/rail/cable/stations/zoo-south-station/] Zoo South Station, 指南宮站 [/rail/cable/stations/zhinan-temple-station/] Zhinan Temple Station, and 貓空站 [/rail/cable/stations/maokong-station/] Maokong Station — plus **two non-boarding angle stations** the alignment needs because it is not straight ("略呈7字型," roughly 7-shaped)^[4] ^[10]. Zoo South Station opened under the name 動物園內站 ("Zoo Interior Station") and was not renamed to its current form until 26 October 2015^[13] — which is why the Control Yuan's 2009 report on the same station still calls it 園內站. One-way journey time is given by the

operator as **20 to 30 minutes**^[9]; zh.wikipedia separately gives approximately 17 minutes, sourced to an in-article footnote not independently checked here^[12] — both figures are published rather than one chosen over the other.

The system's own current page counts **25 pier bases carrying 47 tower columns**, implying most bases carry a two-legged frame; the Control Yuan's 2009 resolution instead gives a single figure of 25 towers for the whole line^[4]^[2]. The whole project's cost is given two ways in that same Control Yuan document — an approximate **NT\$1.3 billion** in its opening summary and a precise **NT\$1,108,870,438** later in the text discussing the planning contractor's survey work — without the document explaining whether the two figures cover different scopes^[2].

The T16 failure

In September 2008 three typhoons crossed Taiwan in eighteen days — 辛樂克 (11–16 September), 哈格比 (21–23 September) and 薔蜜 Jangmi (26–30 September)^[2]. Their combined rainfall reached **1,271.5 mm** for the month in the Muzha [/rail/metro/stations/br02/] area — the Central Weather Bureau's second-highest September figure there in 22 years^[2]. Jangmi's own contribution on 28 September alone was separately measured at roughly 500 mm over Wenshan District, and it was that single day's rain that triggered the report the city acted on^[1].

The slope below tower **T16** began failing on 27 September; its first two sections slid on 28 September, sending debris into the 政大御花園社區 community below and prompting the evacuation of roughly 72 households (about 200 people) that night, with the debris stopping about 20 m short of the nearest building^[2]^[1]. A third, residual section of the slope came down after further heavy rain on 9 November. The city suspended service at **15:00 on 1 October 2008**^[2]^[1].

Taipei's Department of Industrial Development commissioned **four Taipei professional associations** — civil, geotechnical, structural, and soil-and- water-conservation engineering — to assess the failure, T16's remaining safety, and whether the tower should be reinforced in place or moved. Their initial report came 30 November 2008, the full report 12 December^[2]^[1]. It found T16's well-type foundation (井式基礎) left cantilevered by roughly 4 metres, with the overturning moment the exposed foundation would face in an earthquake exceeding what its existing reinforcement could carry — though continuous tilt monitoring installed from late September 2008 found no measurable tilt, displacement or settlement in T16 or any other tower over the following three months^[2]. In-place reinforcement was judged technically possible if carried out early in the slide, which the city did not do; by the time it acted, conditions had worsened enough that the assessors recommended relocation as the safer course^[2].

Taipei City Government relocated T16, rather than rebuilding it in place — a decision the Control Yuan's own corrective resolution explicitly endorses. Engineers compared two candidate drill sites (NH-1, NH-2) toward neighbouring tower T17; POMA's own engineers preferred NH-1 as closest to the original tower's centreline and elevation, and both candidate sites tested with better geology than the original. Mayor Hau Lung-bin announced the new site at a press conference on 23 January 2009; **the rebuilt tower stands about 30 m from where the old one stood**^[2].

The Control Yuan's own November 2009 investigation — carried out by committee members 杜善良, 葛永光 and 陳永祥 over more than eleven months^[3] — went well beyond T16 itself. It rejected public allegations that the foundation piling had been built with substandard materials or that the site had no bedrock at all, but separately found fault with all three of the project's engineering contractors — the planning firm 鼎漢公司, project manager 台灣世曦, and design-build contractor 春原營造 — for inadequate geotechnical survey work along the whole alignment, and with the city government itself for a slow initial emergency response and for never requiring a proper site-wide geological survey in the original planning contract^[2].

Reopening

The gondola reopened in stages in March 2010: Mayor Hau announced on 18 March that formal service would resume 30 March; TRTC `[/rail/operators/trtc/]` published the detailed reopening rules on 21 March; a six-day **free trial** ran 23–28 March, 10,000 free rides a day, 102,000+ riders over the six days; and **formal, paid service resumed 30 March 2010**^[12]. Two figures both appear in sources for "the reopening date" — 23 March and 30 March — and neither is wrong: they are the free trial's start and the formal reopening, respectively, both individually dated in the same source^[12].

The reopening had two small early scares. On 7 April 2010 a tilt-monitoring alarm on neighbouring tower **T15** turned out to be a false alarm, with no actual movement found^[12]. On 9 April, one week after reopening and with cumulative ridership past 100,000, a cable-detection alarm halted the system for 4 minutes 5 seconds that evening — no passengers were trapped, and service resumed within the hour^[12]. By 29 April, ridership since reopening had reached 270,000^[12].

Over its first operating period — 4 July 2007 to 1 October 2008, about 15 months — the gondola carried more than **6.17 million riders**, per zh.wikipedia's own footnoted figure^[12].

The crystal cabins

From the 30 March 2010 reopening, one pilot cabin ran with a transparent floor^[8]. The full "貓纜之眼" ("**Eyes of Maokong**") **crystal-cabin fleet — 31 units — entered service from 2 November 2010**^[8]. Each floor is three layers of tempered glass, about 48 mm thick and 213 kg, CE-certified, and the extra weight costs three seats: a crystal cabin carries 5 passengers against a standard cabin's 8^[8] ^[5]. zh.wikipedia separately gives the crystal cabins' individual numbers as 1–15, 66 and 133–147 (car 66 the original prototype) and puts the whole fleet, standard and crystal together, at **147 cabins including 3 spares**^[12] — a figure not independently checked against a primary fleet roster, though the 31-cabin crystal count matches the operator's own page.

Fares and rules

A single one-way ride costs NT\$180 full fare / NT\$50 discount fare^[5]; an unlimited all-day pass is NT\$300 / NT\$100^[5]. Upgrading to a crystal cabin adds NT\$50 per person per trip; chartering a whole cabin adds NT\$600 per trip^[5]. Groups of 20 or more get 10% off an all-day pass, 40 or more get 20% off^[5]. Discount fares are for Taipei City residents, retired city civil servants and teachers, children 6–11, seniors 65 and over (or Taipei-registered Indigenous residents 55 and over), and people with disabilities plus one companion — shown at boarding and tapped through a dedicated gate with a stored-value card^[5]. EasyCard [\[/ticketing/guides/cards-passes-and-fares/\]](/ticketing/guides/cards-passes-and-fares/) and other stored-value cards work across the whole system^[5]. The operator's current fare page makes no mention of the TPASS 基北北桃1200 monthly pass as an accepted option; a 2023 council-session report says TRTC had evaluated adding the gondola to TPASS but chose not to, to avoid complicating ticketing during the pass's early rollout^[5] ^[14].

Service suspends automatically for a sustained gust of 16 m/s (roughly Beaufort 7) for three seconds or more, any gust of 18 m/s (Beaufort 8) or more, lightning on the route, an earthquake of intensity 4 or greater, or when a land typhoon warning covers Taipei and either weather or a city work/school closure calls for it^[6]. Routine maintenance closes the system on scattered Mondays through the year, plus a separate, longer annual-overhaul block of consecutive Mondays in some months — the published 2026 calendar does not follow a simple "first Monday of the month" pattern^[7].

Now

The gondola is operated by **North Metro Recreation Company** (北捷遊憩事業股份有限公司), a 2025 joint subsidiary of Taipei City Government and TRTC that also runs Taipei Arena [\[/rail/metro/stations/g17/\]](/rail/metro/stations/g17/) and the Taipei Children's Amusement Park^[11]. Cumulative ridership passed **40 million riders on 19 May 2026**, ahead of the system's 20th operating anniversary in July 2027^[9].

Specifications

Route length	4.033 km ^[4]
Stations (passenger)	4 ^[4]
Stations (angle, non-boarding)	2 ^[4]
Pier bases / tower columns	25 / 47 ^[4]
One-way journey time	20–30 min ^[9]
Standard cabin capacity	8 passengers ^[5]
Crystal cabin capacity	5 passengers ^[8]
Crystal cabin fleet	31 ^[8]
Total cabin fleet	147 ^[12]
Standard cabin weight capacity	TBC
Cumulative ridership	40,000,000+ ^[9]

References

11 of 14 sources on this page are primary — published by the operator, the builder or government.

- 1** The Taipei Maokong Gondola T16 tower lower-slope remediation works (part 1) [<http://etimes.twce.org.tw/%E5%9C%B0%E5%B7%A5%E6%8A%80%E8%A1%93/1791-%E8%87%BA%E5%8C%97%E5%B8%82%E8%B2%93%E7%A9%BA%E7%BA%9C%E8%BB%8A%E5%A1%94%E6%9F%B1%E4%B8%8B%E9%82%8A%E5%9D%A1%E6%95%B4%E6%B2%BB%E5%B7%A5%E7%A8%8B%E5%BC%88%E4%B8%8A%E5%BC%89.html>]

臺北市貓空纜車T16塔柱下邊坡整治工程（上）

PRIMARY 台灣省土木技師公會 技師報 (Taiwan Association of Civil Engineering Technicians), author 游裕偉, 臺北市大地工程處 坡地整治科股長 accessed 2026-08-12

Written by the Taipei City geotechnical office's own slope-remediation engineer, published in the technicians' association journal. Source for the contract/construction chronology, T16's location and geology, the initial 27–28 September 2008 landslide, evacuation, and the four-association assessment scope: 「94年5月2日以最有利標方式決標...96年7月4日交由捷運公司正式啟用營運」.
- 2** Corrective resolution against Taipei City Government (Maokong Gondola T16 tower) [<https://cybsbox.cy.gov.tw/CYBSBoxSSL/edoc/download/63975>]

糾正案文（臺北市政府／貓空纜車T16塔柱）

PRIMARY 監察院 (Control Yuan, Republic of China) accessed 2026-08-12

The Control Yuan's own investigative finding, read in full as a PDF. Source for the T16 relocation decision (~30 m from the original site), the four-association assessment body, the ~4 m foundation cantilever, the 1 October 2008 15:00 suspension, the 1,271.5 mm September rainfall (CWB figure), and the resolution's criticism of the planning, project-management and design-build contractors: 「臺北市政府遷移T16塔柱，應是正確決策」.

- 3 Case: Landslide below the Maokong Gondola T16 tower [https://www.cy.gov.tw/News_Content.aspx?n=124&s=4853]
「臺北市貓空纜車T16塔柱下方邊坡崩塌」案
PRIMARY 監察院 (Control Yuan, Republic of China) accessed 2026-08-12
The Control Yuan's own case-summary page naming the investigating members and the 4 November 2009 release of the corrective resolution. Read via a tool-generated summary rather than raw HTML, unlike the resolution PDF itself.
-
- 4 Route and system [https://www.gondola.taipei/cp.aspx?n=8FE9610BDDDB5332A]
路線與系統
PRIMARY 貓空纜車網站 (gondola.taipei), operated by 北捷遊憩事業股份有限公司 accessed 2026-08-12
The operator's current system-overview page, fetched as raw HTML. Source for the current 4.033 km length, the 6-station/25-pier/47-column count, and the four passenger station names: 「纜車全程共計6個場站（4個車站、2個轉角站）及25處墩座、47支塔柱，全長4.033公里」.
-
- 5 Fares [https://www.gondola.taipei/cp.aspx?n=E6E0CD5467B035F9]
票價
PRIMARY 貓空纜車網站 (gondola.taipei) accessed 2026-08-12
The operator's current fare table, fetched as raw HTML (page self-dated as last updated 2025-08-28). Source for all fare figures, the 8-passenger standard cabin capacity, discount eligibility, and the absence of any TPASS/monthly-pass option on the page.
-
- 6 Suspension conditions [https://www.gondola.taipei/cp.aspx?n=94839749F15BBAB1]
暫停營運條件
PRIMARY 貓空纜車網站 (gondola.taipei) accessed 2026-08-12
Source for the four numeric/categorical suspension thresholds: 「當瞬間風速達16公尺/秒（約7級風）且持續3秒以上，或瞬間風速18公尺/秒（約8級風）以上時，將暫停營運」.
-
- 7 Operating hours [https://www.gondola.taipei/cp.aspx?n=BFE4B2ABA0D9FB61]
營運時間
PRIMARY 貓空纜車網站 (gondola.taipei) accessed 2026-08-12
The published 2026 maintenance-closure calendar, fetched as raw HTML. Shows routine Monday closures scattered through each month plus a separate multi-week annual-overhaul block, not a simple 'first Monday' rule.
-
- 8 "Eyes of Maokong" crystal cabins [https://www.gondola.taipei/cp.aspx?n=004537494D1F58B3]
貓纜之眼水晶車廂
PRIMARY 貓空纜車網站 (gondola.taipei) accessed 2026-08-12
Source for the 31-cabin crystal fleet, the glass-floor construction (3 layers, ≈48 mm, ≈213 kg), CE certification, 5-passenger limit, and the 2 November 2010 launch: 「「貓纜之眼」水晶車廂共推出31臺」.
-
- 9 Maokong Gondola ridership passes 40 million, ahead of its 20th operating anniversary [https://www.gov.taipei/News_Content.aspx?n=F0DDAF49B89E9413&sms=72544237BBE4C5F6&s=2866FA29D48270E7]
貓空纜車運量突破4,000萬人次 邁向營運20周年再創觀光里程碑

PRIMARY 臺北市政府 (Taipei City Government) accessed 2026-08-12

City government press release, fetched as raw HTML. Source for the 40-million cumulative ridership figure (passed 19 May 2026) and the 20–30 minute one-way journey time: 「貓空纜車累計運量於5月19日正式突破4,000萬人次」.

10 Stations [<https://english.gondola.taipei/cp.aspx?n=0D063A42CCAFFBEF>]

PRIMARY Maokong Gondola (english.gondola.taipei), operated by North Metro Recreation Company accessed 2026-08-12

The operator's own English-language site. Source for the official English station names (Taipei City Zoo Station, Taipei City Zoo South Station, Zhinan Temple Station, Maokong Station). Located and read via search-engine summary rather than an independently fetched raw page.

11 Company profile [<https://tmr.taipei/cp.aspx?n=F509534D943F1426&s=54D5ADE08DA276E4>]

公司簡介

PRIMARY 北捷遊憩事業股份有限公司 (North Metro Recreation Company) accessed 2026-08-12

The operator's own company profile, establishing it as a 2025 joint subsidiary of Taipei City Government and TRTC, also running Taipei Arena and the Taipei Children's Amusement Park. Located and read via search-engine summary rather than an independently fetched raw page.

12 Maokong Gondola [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/貓空纜車>]

貓空纜車

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-12

Fetched as raw HTML directly, not a summary. Source for the 2010 reopening chronology (18/21/23–28/30 March, 7 and 9 April), the 2007–2008 pre-closure ridership (6.17 million+), the 147-cabin total fleet and crystal-cabin numbering (1–15, 66, 133–147), and the 17-minute one-way time that conflicts with the operator's own 20–30 minute figure. Individual in-article footnotes were not independently re-fetched.

13 Zoo South Station [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/動物園南站>]

動物園南站

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-12

Source for the station's former name (動物園內站, 'Zoo Interior Station') and its 26 October 2015 renaming, which explains the different name (園內站) used for the same station in the Control Yuan's 2009 resolution.

14 Gondola ridership up 1.7% on pre-pandemic levels; councillor asks about adding it to the NT\$1,200 pass [<https://www.ettoday.net/news/20230711/2537856.htm>]

貓纜搭乘量較疫情前「成長1.7%」 趙紹廉：可討論納入1200月票內

SECONDARY ETtoday, 11 July 2023 accessed 2026-08-12

Contemporaneous council-session coverage reporting that TRTC evaluated but did not add the gondola to the TPASS 基北北桃1200 monthly pass, to avoid complicating ticketing during the pass's early rollout. Not independently checked against a council transcript.

An independent, non-commercial reference site. Not affiliated with any transit operator or government body in Taiwan. Line colours are the official values published by each operator through Taiwan MOTC's open data platform. **About this site.**

Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.